

Lab 44 Worksheet — Data Destruction, Disposal and Regulated Data Handling

Name: ____ Date: ____

Exam objective: Select the correct data destruction method for a stated sensitivity and retention requirement, and handle regulated data according to its legal obligations (Core 2 objectives 2.8 and 4.6).

Record as you go

Step	What you did	What you observed
1	Separate the two destruction goals: physical destruction where the media will never be reused, and sanitisation where the media is to be reused or resold.	
2	Record the physical destruction methods: drilling through the platters, shredding into small fragments, degaussing with a strong magnetic field, and incineration.	
3	Record the critical exception: degaussing does not work on solid state drives, because SSDs store data in flash cells rather than magnetically. Shredding or cryptographic erase is required instead.	
4	Record the sanitisation methods for reuse: a standard format which only clears the file table, a low-level format, and a multi-pass overwrite wipe which is the only reliable software method on a hard disk.	
5	Record why a standard format is not destruction: it removes the index but leaves the data recoverable with freely available tools.	
6	Record cryptographic erase for self-encrypting drives: destroying the encryption key renders all data unrecoverable instantly, which is the fastest	

Step	What you did	What you observed
	correct method for an SED or an encrypted SSD.	
7	Build the decision table matching data sensitivity to method: public data may simply be deleted, internal data must be wiped, confidential data must be wiped and verified, and regulated data must be physically destroyed with a certificate.	
8	Record the outsourcing requirements: use a certified vendor, obtain a certificate of destruction listing serial numbers, and retain that certificate for the audit period.	
9	Build the regulated data reference: personally identifiable information, PCI DSS for payment card data, GDPR for EU personal data, PHI under HIPAA for health data, and Singapore's PDPA.	
10	For each regulation record what data it covers, the core obligation it imposes and the consequence of a breach.	
11	Record the chain of custody: the chronological documentation of who held evidence, when, and what they did with it, and note that a gap in the chain can render evidence inadmissible.	
12	Complete a chain-of-custody form for a hypothetical drive removed from a compromised machine, recording every handover with date, time, person and purpose.	

Verification

Success criterion: Your decision table gives a method for all four sensitivity levels; you correctly state that degaussing does not work on SSDs; the regulated data reference covers at least five frameworks with obligations; and the chain-of-custody form has no gaps between handovers.

- I completed every step in the lab.
- My result meets the success criterion above.
- I recorded my evidence (screenshots, output, completed tables).

Reflection

What surprised you in this lab?

Where would you apply this on the job?

What do you still need to revise before the exam?
